

First Esports Real Time Strategy King

1996

Long before sold-out esports arenas filled stadiums in Seoul or multi-million dollar streaming contracts transformed digital competition into global entertainment, the internet gaming landscape was an uncharted frontier. In the late 1990s, three elements collided to spark a revolution: Kali an early [IPX](#) network emulator enabling legacy [multiplayer](#) games to work over a modern [TCP/IP](#), competitive ranking structures like Case's Ladder, and the real-time strategy (RTS) games themselves.

At the center of this transformation was Wayne Chiang, known online as **SoSOWAC** (and later **D22-soso**). Before he became the first-ever *StarCraft: Brood War* World Champion, Chiang laid the concrete foundation for competitive gaming across *Command & Conquer* and *Warcraft II*, while keeping a foot print on *Magic: The Gathering*, earning a reputation as a pioneer whose strategic mind defined an era and echoes to today.. After being introduced to competitive Magic: the Gathering through legend Brian Weissman, Chiang found his true calling.

1996 - The Dawn of RTS: Command & Conquer

Command & Conquer: Tiberian Dawn (1995) forged the blueprint for modern digital strategy. Through Kali, Wayne "SoSOWAC" Chiang shot up the ranks on Case's Ladder, mentored by Case's Ladder co-owner Bill "Bill1" Macaitis. Chiang defined C&C gameplay and the entire metagame: His team **Synergy** held the #1 ranking on the Command & Conquer Case's Team Ladder while they were active.

							
		THE C&C LADDER					
		(as of 6/24/96)					
Current Rank	Name	Wins	Losses	Win/Loss %	Last Game	High Rank	Win/Loss Streak
1	<u>SoSOWAC</u>	87	16	84.47%	6/23/96	1	n/a

1997 - Escallation: Warcraft II

Warcraft II: Tides of Darkness (1995) elevated fantasy strategy with fog-of-war mechanics, naval combat, and macro management, Chiang transitioned to Kali's competitive circuit. Joining **Clan C4L**, he achieved Top 3 rankings in 1v1 play and held the #1 team spot. He first met rivals and future teammates Jay "Gadianton" Severson (co-founder Chess.com).

Rank	Name	Won-Lost	Glicko Rating	Win %	Streak	Days Idle	Ranks Played		Peer Ratings		Highest Achieved		
							Average	Higher	Honor	Skill	Rank	Glicko	Streak
1	iLLuminati	100-28	2058	78.12%	+5	0.1	188.3	29.7%	8.05	7.85	1	2081	+22
2	~ArchAngel	86-19	2421	81.90%	+1	1.4	114.9	35.2%	8.16	7.92	2	2424	+15
3	suiCi))al	19-13	1763	59.38%	+1	0.7	45.1	53.1%	6.75	7.90	3	1783	+4
4	Tom and Rob	80-9	2358	89.89%	+4	0.4	295.9	22.5%	6.77	7.97	4	2358	+26
5	sosowac	14-2	1967	87.50%	+5	1.3	56.9	87.5%	6.67	7.95	4	1967	+6

1998-2000 The StarCraft: Brood War First World Champion

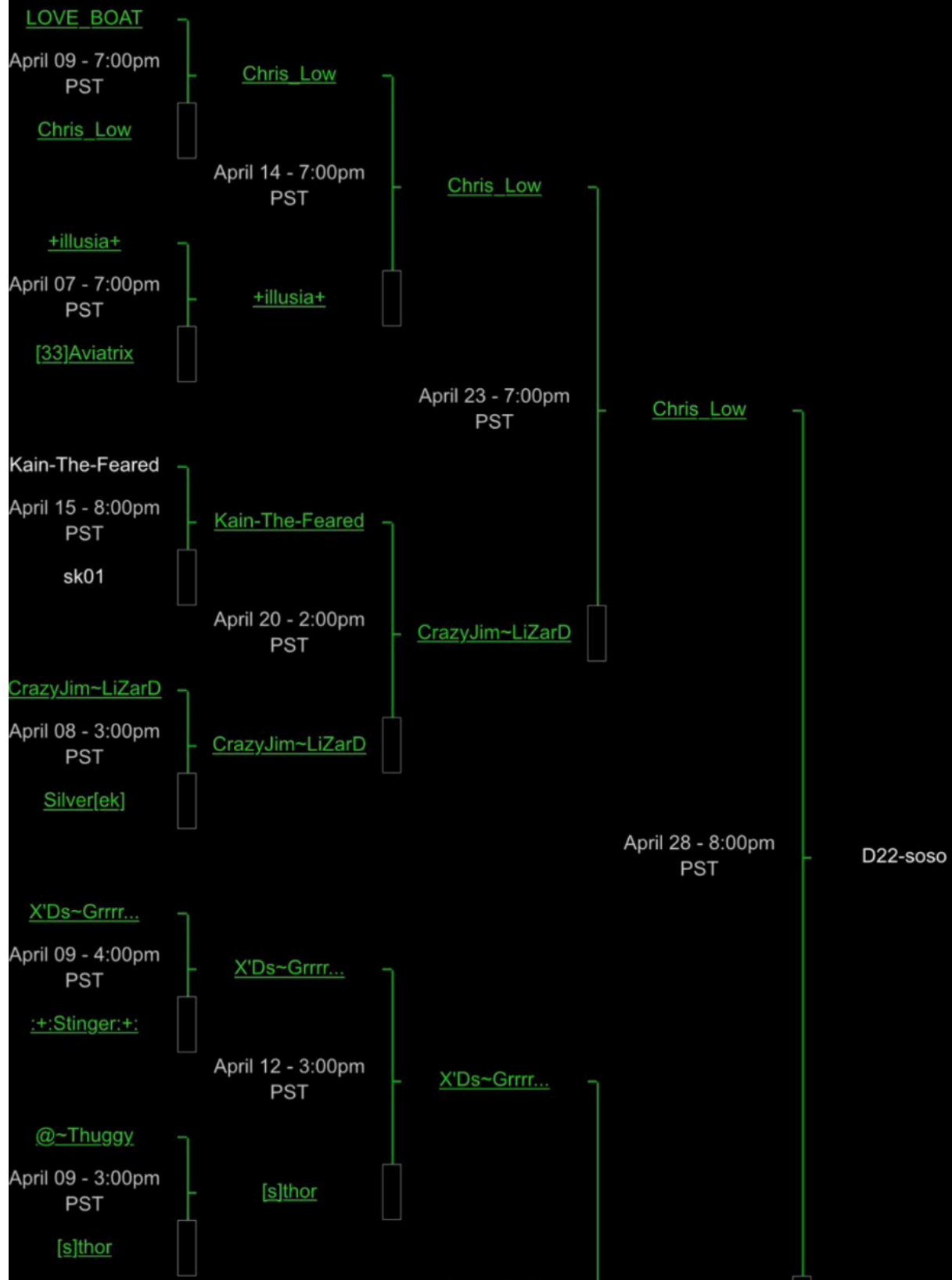
On March 31, 1998, Blizzard Entertainment released *StarCraft*, permanently changing competitive gaming. Chiang immediately captured the #1 spot on Case's Ladder in both 1v1 and team divisions, winning the inaugural local *StarCraft* tournament at Neutral Ground in Mountain View, California against his longtime rival Jay Severson.

Transitioning into community building, Chiang joined forces with esports figures Dennis "Thresh" Fong and Bob "Calbear" Colayco at Gamers.com running GX StarCraft. Adopting the tag **D22-soso**, Chiang served as *StarCraft*'s first tournament caster during PGL Season 3, blogging the international tournaments, authored battle reports immediately after tournament and ladder matches analyzing top-tier ladder play, and pioneered community media concepts like *Pimpest Plays*—the structural blueprint for modern esports highlight reels.

1999 Brood War Season 1 Ladder Tournament(<https://classic.battle.net/scc/br/bws1final5.shtml>)
D22-soso was crowned the first StsrCraft Brood War World Champion playing Random.







Competitive History:

StarCraft 1 vs. 1 Case's Ladder #1 1998

StarCraft Team Case's Ladder #1 1998

Top 20 Battle.net April 1998 - Dec 1999

Neutral Ground Mountain View StarCraft Tournament 1st Place(1st StarCraft Tournament Winner) 1998

February 1999 B.net vs Kali #2 Seed vs. Guillaume Patry

April 1999 StarCraft Brood War Battle.net Season 1 World Champion 1999

May 1999 PGL Season 4 Starcraft World Championship 2nd Place 1999

June USA Vs. Canada MVP 1999

July 1999 Sports Seoul Starcraft Brood War #5 1999

July 1999 StarCraft World Champions Invitational #3 1999

September 1999 Starcraft Brood War Battle.net World Championships #3, 1999

D22-soso Full History via Zombie Grub's GLHF.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CHd4-eZx2Do>

Liquipedia:

<https://liquipedia.net/starcraft/Soso>

2001-2002 - Magic: the Gathering - Chiang's Pure Esports Finale

Concurrently with real time strategy dominance since 1996, Chiang engaged in high-level play in *Magic: The Gathering*. Early encounters with Pro Tour titan Brian Weissman at Palo Alto hotspot Round Table Pizza helped sharpen Chiang's understanding of card advantage, resource efficiency, and tempo.

Although Chiang treated *Magic* primarily as a side game, he consistently made Top 8 appearances at PTQs and developed early custom formats like "The Cube" which is now the modern Cube Draft format to create dynamic, cost-effective draft environments.

After moving on from competitive real time strategy, Wayne Chiang qualified for 3 Magic: the Gathering Pro Tours attending Pro Tour New York 2001 and Pro Tour Boston 2002. The Cube would eventually become popularized to be one of the most beloved Magic: The Gathering formats of all time being a staple on Magic Online.

Magic: the Gathering History: The Cube:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MNjLKeA-08A>

2002 and beyond - Casual Competitor

WarCraft 3 #2 rank AT US West

WarCraft 3 #1 Rank FFA US West

Clash Royale Challenger

League of Legends Diamond 5

Hearthstone #35 Rank Standard

Hearthstone #11 Rank Wild

#1 Rank Once Upon a Galaxy